

PRIORITIES

Monday

Example: Children learn fire burns without randomized trials.

Causation is not directly observed  $\rightarrow$  propounded by David Hume

1. What we think we see vs what we actually see

Take a simple example:

A billiard ball hits another  $\rightarrow$  second ball moves.

We instinctively say: the first ball caused the second to move.

But what do we actually observe?

Only this:

- event A happens • event B follows • repeatedly
- We never observe: • a "force link" • a "causal power"
- a "necessary connection"

We only see: sequence + regularity

2. Hume's radical claim

Hume said: Causation is not something in the world we directly perceive. It is something the mind infers after repeated patterns.

| March 2024 |    |    |    |    |    |    | April 2024 |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|------------|----|----|----|----|----|----|------------|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| Mo         | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su | Mo         | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su |
|            |    |    |    |    | 1  | 2  | 3          | 4  | 5  | 6  | 7  | 8  | 9  |
| 10         | 11 | 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16 | 17         | 18 | 19 | 20 | 21 | 22 | 23 |
| 24         | 25 | 26 | 27 | 28 | 29 | 30 | 31         | 1  | 2  | 3  | 4  | 5  | 6  |
|            |    |    |    |    |    |    |            | 7  | 8  | 9  | 10 | 11 | 12 |
|            |    |    |    |    |    |    |            | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16 | 17 | 18 |
|            |    |    |    |    |    |    |            | 19 | 20 | 21 | 22 | 23 | 24 |
|            |    |    |    |    |    |    |            | 25 | 26 | 27 | 28 | 29 | 30 |
|            |    |    |    |    |    |    |            | 31 |    |    |    |    |    |